

ADO Vocabulary Card

Day 2 handout. The Azure DevOps terms to keep straight while you load the feature and draft DP §2 — with the TPM-relevant signal each one carries.

Use this as your reference while you build the hierarchy, populate fields, and write queries. You don't have to *administer* ADO — you have to name these clearly enough that an engineering team could pick up your backlog Monday.

TERM	WHAT IT IS	TPM-RELEVANT
Work item	The atomic unit (Epic, Feature, User Story, Task, Bug)	Everything tracked is one of these
Hierarchy	Epic → Feature → User Story → Task	The default in the Agile process; configurable
Area path	Logical product area (<code>Reconcile / Mobile</code>)	Filters reports
Iteration path	Sprint number / time window	When the work is scheduled
State	New / Active / Resolved / Closed (varies by template)	Workflow status
Tags	Free-form labels	Cross-cutting filters (<code>security-review</code> , <code>customer-XYZ</code>)
Story points	Effort estimate (typically Fibonacci: 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13)	Velocity input
Acceptance Criteria	The criteria from PRD §6, attached to the work item	Definition of done
Query (WIQL)	A saved filter	"Show me everything in this state / iteration / tag"
Board	Kanban view of work items	Visual flow
Backlog	Prioritized list view	Planning view
Sprint board	Filtered Kanban for the current iteration	Daily-standup view

The one discipline to remember: most teams populate the title and skip every other field. The cost of skipping shows up at sprint review when nobody can find anything. The cost of populating them is ~5 minutes per item.